VESPER DIGITAL / DOCUMENT TRAIL

THE RULE THAT VANISHED.

Canada × Türkiye · AI and autonomous weapons · May–October 2026

THE CENTRAL ISSUE

Why did Canada want weaker rules?

The UN wanted countries to stop making, storing and selling AI-controlled weapons that cannot follow the rules of war, including weapons that cannot reliably tell civilians from soldiers. Canada wanted that ban weakened. Türkiye wanted it removed completely. The next day, the UN dropped it.

UNITED NATIONS

THE ORIGINAL WORDING

SHALL

Countries MUST prohibit certain weapons

CANADA PROPOSED

MAY

The prohibition becomes optional

United Nations · September 2 negotiation ↗

THE RULE THAT VANISHED.

Canada × Türkiye · AI and autonomous weapons · May–October 2026

MAY 6, 2026

Canadian and Turkish companies team up

On May 6, Kraken Robotics of Canada and Türkiye’s SEFINE agree to develop software that automatically recognizes underwater targets. Kraken already held Canadian Navy contracts announced in 2022 worth up to C$57.9 million. That is earlier defence work, not the value of this new deal.





Kraken Robotics · original announcement ↗

THE RULE THAT VANISHED.

Canada × Türkiye · AI and autonomous weapons · May–October 2026

JULY 7, 2026

Carney meets Türkiye’s president

Carney meets President Erdoğan in Türkiye. They discuss making more military equipment together, new technology, Ukraine, and closer business ties.



Türkiye Today · July 2026

Prime Minister’s Office · meeting readout ↗

THE RULE THAT VANISHED.

Canada × Türkiye · AI and autonomous weapons · May–October 2026

JULY 23, 2026

Canada launches a major drone program

Canada announces plans to build more military drones at home. The program includes drones carrying explosives, systems that stop enemy drones, and technology for accurate attacks.

CANADA · NATIONAL DEFENCE

DEFENCE DRONE INITIATIVE

- Armed drones
- Counter-drone systems
- Precision-strike technology

National Defence · Defence Drone Initiative ↗

THE RULE THAT VANISHED.

Canada × Türkiye · AI and autonomous weapons · May–October 2026

SEPTEMBER 2, 2026 · UN

Türkiye wants the weapons ban removed

At the UN, Türkiye objects to a proposed rule that would stop countries making, buying, storing or selling autonomous weapons that cannot follow the rules of war. Türkiye says the ban could interfere with its military plans and defence industry.



United Nations · September 2 recording ↗

THE RULE THAT VANISHED.

Canada × Türkiye · AI and autonomous weapons · May–October 2026

SEPTEMBER 2, 2026 · UN

Canada asks the UN to weaken the ban

The proposed rule says countries MUST ban these weapons. Canada wants the wording changed to SHOULD or MAY, so countries would have more choice about whether to ban them.

UNITED NATIONS

CANADA'S PROPOSED WORDING

~~SHALL~~

MAY

or SHOULD

Mandatory → optional

United Nations · Canada's intervention ↗

THE RULE THAT VANISHED.

Canada × Türkiye · AI and autonomous weapons · May–October 2026

SEPTEMBER 3, 2026 · UN

The UN drops the proposed ban

The UN meeting chair says countries cannot agree on the wording. Rather than keep the mandatory ban, he removes the entire paragraph from the draft. No new ban is agreed at that meeting.

UNITED NATIONS

SEPTEMBER 3, 2026

PARA 34

REMOVED

The chair deletes the disputed paragraph from the negotiating draft.

United Nations · chair's explanation ↗

THE RULE THAT VANISHED.

Canada × Türkiye · AI and autonomous weapons · May–October 2026

SEPTEMBER 10, 2026

Canada plans to make more drones for Ukraine

Carney announces up to C$50 million in initial drone and unmanned-vehicle contracts. Canada wants factories capable of making millions of drones, and announces plans to produce military drones with Ukraine.

DRONE PRODUCTION PARTNERSHIP

🇨🇦 CANADA

+

🇺🇦 UKRAINE

Joint manufacturing and supply of military drones

Prime Minister’s Office · Ukraine drone announcement ↗

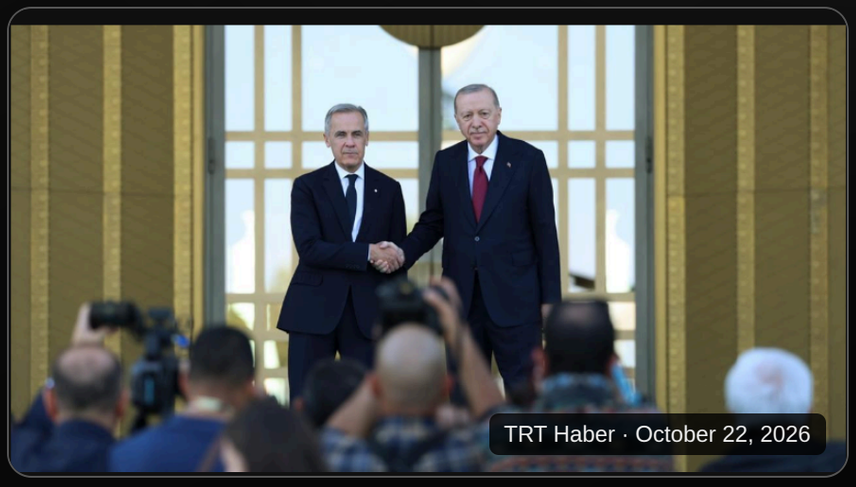
THE RULE THAT VANISHED.

Canada × Türkiye · AI and autonomous weapons · May–October 2026

OCTOBER 22, 2026

Carney returns to Türkiye to expand defence ties

Carney meets Erdoğan in Ankara and the two governments announce deeper cooperation in defence manufacturing, aerospace and advanced technology. This is a second, separate meeting from July.



TRT Haber · October 22, 2026

Prime Minister’s Office · joint statement ↗

THE RULE THAT VANISHED.

Canada × Türkiye · AI and autonomous weapons · May–October 2026

CARNEY'S OWN WORDS · OCTOBER 22

“export opportunities abroad”

From Carney's remarks alongside President Erdoğan

OCTOBER 22, 2026

Carney talks about selling military equipment

Speaking beside Erdoğan, Carney says the new defence agreement will help Canadian and Turkish companies work together and sell military products to other countries.

Prime Minister’s Office · Carney’s speech ↗

THE RULE THAT VANISHED.

Canada × Türkiye · AI and autonomous weapons · May–October 2026

OCTOBER 23, 2026

Another Canadian–Turkish defence deal

CIEL Defence of Canada signs an agreement with Turkish defence company ASELSAN to explore production in Canada, technology sharing and future exports. No contract dollar value has been announced.



Signing photo · True North Strategic Review

CIEL Capital · signed October 23, announced October 29 ↗

THE RULE THAT VANISHED.

Canada × Türkiye · AI and autonomous weapons · May–October 2026

NOVEMBER 5, 2026 · BUDGET

C$2.3 billion for Canada’s drone industry

Budget 2026 proposes C$2.3 billion over five years, starting in 2027–28, for buying and deploying drones and counter-drone systems. It is proposed program funding, not money awarded to the Turkish partnerships.

BUDGET 2026 · NOVEMBER 5

C$2.3B

Proposed over five years
Starting 2027–28

Drones · Counter-drone systems
Acquisition and deployment

Budget 2026 · Chapter 5, Defence Drone Initiative ↗

THE RULE THAT VANISHED.

Canada × Türkiye · AI and autonomous weapons · May–October 2026

THE QUESTION

Why does this timeline matter?

Canada asked to soften the proposed UN ban. Türkiye wanted it deleted. The paragraph was removed. The countries then deepened defence-industry ties, and Budget 2026 proposed C$2.3 billion for Canadian drone capabilities. What kinds of weapons will these partnerships build and sell?

UNITED NATIONS

THE SEQUENCE

PARTNERSHIPS

→ UN DEBATE

→ EXPORTS

Budget 2026: C$2.3 billion proposed for drone capabilities.

United Nations · chair’s September 3 explanation ↗